Wiscasset Select Board, Tax Assessors & Overseers of the Poor

9/1/2026 - Minutes

1. Call The Meeting To Order

   Alissa Eason called the meeting to order at 6 p.m.

   Present: Pam Dunning, Chair Alissa Eason, Heather Jones, Cassaundra Rose and Sarah Whitfield, and Town Manager Dennis Simmons

2. Pledge Of Allegiance

3. Consent Agenda Items

   a. Payroll Warrants: August 21, 2026 and August 28, 2026

   b. Accounts Payable Warrants: August 25, 2026 and September 1, 2026.

   c. Approval of Minutes of August 18, 2026

   d. Committee Appointments: Cindy Dionne. Sharon Babcock, and James Crowley to the ad hoc WWTP Outreach Committee

4. Public Comment

   none

5. Unfinished Business

   a. Certification of the Fire Department Cost Recovery Ordinance

   Pam Dunning moved to certify the Fire Department Cost Recovery Ordinance and place the question on the November 3, 2026 Special Town Meeting Warrant. Vote 5-0-0.

   b. Certification of the Data Center Moratorium Ordinance

   Pam Dunning moved to certify the Data Center Moratorium and place the question on the November 3, 2026 Special Town Meeting Warrant. Vote 5-0-0.

   c. Certification of Town Officials Ordinance; Ordinance Review Committee Proposed Revisions

   Included in the discussion were a summary of the ORC's responsibilities, the recent difficulties in reaching a quorum, and the opinion that ORC duties could be done by town personnel.

   Pam Dunning moved to certify the proposed Town Officials Ordinance revisions and place the question on the November 3, 2026, Special Town Meeting Warrant. Vote 4-0-1.

   d. Certification of the Mobile Home Park Rent Increase Moratorium.

   Alissa Eason said that this subject came to the Select Board too late to act on it and therefore a moratorium on rent increases at mobile home parks for six months is being proposed.

Pam Dunning moved to certify the Mobile Home Park Rent Increase Moratorium Ordinance and place the question on the November 3, 2026 Special Town Meeting Warrant.

Under the 180-day moratorium, rent increases would be retroactive to September 1, 2026; and the moratorium could be extended. Samantha Beers, owner of the Maplewood Mobile Home Park spoke about the extensive and expensive improvements they had made to the park since purchasing it.

Pam rescinded her motion in order for additional language regarding extending the moratorium.

Alissa Eason moved to certify the Mobile Home Park Rent Increase Moratorium Ordinance as amended and place the question on the November 3, 2026 Special Town Meeting Warrant. Vote 5-0-0.

6. New Business

a. Sewer Abatement

Pam Dunning moved to approve a sewer abatement for account #165 in the amount of $441.40. Vote 5-0-0.

b. Community Center Hot Tub Donation.

Pam Dunning moved to approve acceptance of an anonymous donation of $50,000 toward improvements of the Community Center facility including upgrades to its fitness equipment and installation of an in-floor hot Tub. Vote 5-0-0.

c. Transfer of Funds from the WCC Special Revenue Donation Account to the WCC Hot Tub Special Revenue Account.

Pam Dunning moved to approve the transfer of $30,000 from the Community Center Special Revenue Donation account to the Community Center Hot Tub Special Revenue Account. Vote 5-0-0.

d. Community Center Membership Fees

Alissa Eason moved to approve the 2026 Schedule of Membership Fees for use of the Community Center as amended to add the option for yearly fees to be paid monthly. Vote 5-0-0.

e. November 3, 2026, Special Town Meeting Warrant

Cassaundra Rose moved to approve the warrant for a Special Town Meeting November 3, 2026. Vote 5-0-0.

f. Sherman Park Restoration Project

Pam Dunning moved to award a contract to Hagar Enterprises for $30,897 for the Sherman Park Restoration Project as recommended by the Town Manager. Vote 5-0-0.

g. Maine Redevelopment Land Bank Authority Property Stabilization Grant-Mason Station Storage Warehouse.

Pam Dunning moved to authorize the Town Manager to apply for a Maine Redevelopment Land Bank Authority Lightning Stabilization Warehouse on the Mason Station property. Vote 5-0-0.

h. Obtaining Quotes on Reducing Town Building Maintenance Costs through Efficiency Improvements.

Rose requested that the manager obtain quotes for efficiency upgrades like air sealing and insulation

following recommendations from energy audits that will be finalized later this year. Vote 5-0-0.

7. Town Manager's Report

   Heather Jones thanked the Town Manager for his quick work on the mobile home rent increase moratorium.

   Dennis Simmons will not be in the office on Thursday, September 3, 2026.

8. Adjourn

   Sarah Whitfield moved to adjourn the meeting at 7:37 p.m. Vote 5-0-0.